



DATA RECOVERY

R-Studio FAT comes across as a recovery software developed for system administrators rather than for an average home user. This is well reflected by the interface which is very detailed, and lists out the details of every storage device connected to the computer.

R-Studio was the only tool that supported remote recovery over a network. It supports the creation of disk images which are perfect byte-by-byte copies of entire partitions. Though the software cannot schedule regular creation of disk images, the images we obtained were perfect copies. Another useful feature is the support for making software RAIDs or virtual volumes. Virtual volumes are a feature by which partitions can be spread across separate physical disks without the need for separate hardware controllers.

The manual is a little complex, and is targeted at advanced users—a little simplicity would be desirable.

We deleted 15 files, and tried to recover them with the software. R-Studio was able to completely recover 7 files, and par-

R-Studio FAT

+ Feature-rich, has in-built restoration capability

– Cryptic interface that needs some technical expertise

Price: \$49.99

Developer: R Tools Technology Inc.

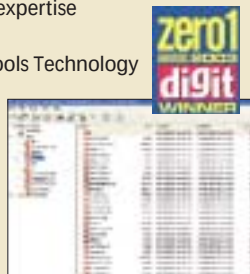
Website:

www.r-tt.com

Reviewed In:

November

2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: NA

2001: NA

tially recover another 7. It only lost 1 file.

The software was also able to satisfactorily recover the partition we deleted. Though the file structure was not saved, the data was.

R-Studio is a tool more suitable for

WORTHY MENTIONS

Ontrack EasyRecovery Professional 6.03

+ Very simple and easy-to-use interface

– Slow scanning

Price: \$499

Developer: Ontrack Data Recovery Services

Website: www.ontrack.com

Reviewed In: November 2003

Stellar Phoenix FAT & NTFS

+ Very low scanning and recovery time, very small installation size

– Low on features

Price: \$149

Developer: Stellar Information Systems

Website: www.stellarinfo.com

Reviewed In: November 2003

professionals rather than home users, as it offers a few extra utilities which otherwise would cost more to procure. It is the only tool that has system restoration capabilities. All these features come packed in just 3.39 MB of data, as compared to 53.6 MB for Ontrack EasyRecovery.

FIREWALLS

The Internet is one of the best things that's ever happened to mankind.

But like all good things in life, it comes with its share of woes. What was once meant to be a means for sharing important information across geographical boundaries has now turned into something that lets crackers sit in the comfort of their dens and wreak havoc on unsuspecting users. Securing systems and data from such malicious activity has been the top concern of leading corporate houses across the globe, and has led to a billion-dollar Internet security industry. Almost all organisations employ the services of professional security companies to secure their networks from crackers. Despite this, there has been an increase in cracking activity and security exploits worldwide.

ZoneAlarm has been one of the best firewalls for quite some time, and it was no different this time. It's very easy to install and configure, and provides very good protection. Immediately after the install, a configuration wizard pops up, which lets you set up things such as privacy control, level of alerting, and pass-

ZoneLabs ZoneAlarm Pro v3.7.159

+ Excellent performance

– High system load

Price: \$40

Web site: www.zonelabs.com

Reviewed In: July 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: NA

2001: Zone Alarm Pro 2.6

word protection. You can also let ZoneAlarm configure permissions for the browser and its components to let it access the Internet. After this, you can

WORTHY MENTIONS

Norton Personal Firewall 2003

+ Excellent resistance to port scanning

– Expensive

Price: \$49.95

Web site: www.symantec.com

Reviewed In: July 2003

McAfee Personal Firewall Plus

+ Pie chart of the most frequently blocked ports, blocks open ports from within IE

– Does not display a graph of local port activity and Internet traffic, fails to stop port from uploading to server

Price: \$44.95

Web site: www.mcafee.com

Reviewed In: July 2003

walk through a nine-step tutorial that will get you started with configuring the firewall. The MailSafe feature lets you quarantine or allow attachments based on their file types. With all its bells and whistles, ZoneAlarm does place some serious overhead on your Internet browser, but then again, security is all that matters, right?